



Project Overview

In 2023, **Metro West Collaborative Development** was selected by the Natick Select Board to preserve and re-purpose the Eliot School to create **32 affordable apartments** at 5 Auburn Street. The selection of Metro West CD as the developer was made through an extensive RFP process.

The development proposes to **preserve the historic Eliot School** and maintain the front lawn and historic sight lines to the school building. The school building is planned to house apartments, a community room, and office space for property management. A second, three story building will be constructed and pursue **Passive House** certification. The development will create high-quality, 100% affordable homes that will serve households at and below 30% and 60% of Area Median Income. All apartments will remain 100% affordable in **perpetuity**.

A Comprehensive Permit was unanimously approved in Summer 2025. The development is undergoing review for a Notice of Intent and Major Stormwater Permit and will submit a pre-application for state funds in Fall 2025.



Highlights

- ✓ 32 Affordable Rental Apartments
- ✓ Serve 30% and 60% AMI Households
- ✓ Sustainable, Accessible Design
- ✓ Preservation of Historic Eliot School and Front Lawn
- ✓ 70% Local Preference for Eligible Apartments

Sign Up for Updates

✉ 5Auburn@metrowestcd.org

Learn more by visiting our project website:
www.5Auburn.com

Frequently Asked Questions

Who is Metro West CD?

Metro West CD, founded in 1991, is a regional **non-profit community development corporation** with a track record of completing successful affordable housing developments. We have developed 205 units of affordable housing with an additional 75 units in the construction pipeline, including 5 Auburn Street. Visit metrowestcd.org for more information.

Why is Affordable Housing needed in Natick?

Natick's growing need for affordable housing is driven by high demand, rising costs, and a severely limited inventory, making it increasingly difficult for many residents to find and maintain affordable homes. Natick's Housing Production Plan notes that nearly one-third of renters and homeowners are considered housing cost-burdened, paying more than 30% of their income on housing expenses. According to Housing Navigator MA, of the approximately 1,500 Subsidized Housing Inventory (SHI) units in Natick, **only approximately 837 units are affordable apartments** (the rest are market rate). Of these 837 affordable apartments, 541 are age restricted, **leaving only 296 apartments for other individuals and families**. With market vacancy at just 1%, this demonstrates an extremely limited supply.

Why is Metro West CD requesting CPA Funds?

Metro West CD is requesting CPA funds now for 2 reasons: **1) financial need** due to the presence of significant hazardous materials in the Eliot School, design changes during permitting, and changes to Low Income Housing Tax Credit (LIHTC) equity pricing; and **2) timing** - a commitment of CPA funds now helps make our "OneStop" application for state funds far more competitive and increases chances of a funding award. If the project doesn't receive funding from the state it could result in a 6-12 month delay, increasing risk of deterioration of the Eliot School as it remains vacant. While the project needs a CPC commitment now, MWCD would not be looking to receive the committed funds until construction start or once construction has begun.

What will CPA funding be used for?

CPA funds will be used for the general **costs of construction** for the rehabilitation of the historic Eliot School into nine (9) apartments and the new construction of twenty-three (23) apartments.

How do CPA funds contribute to the total project budget?

CPA funds would make up **just 3% of the estimated total project budget**, however the impact would be meaningful. For every \$1 of CPA funding provided, the project would be able to access approximately \$30 in other funds to support the production of 32 units of 100% affordable housing to serve the Natick community. Other Metro West CD developments have received CPA funds that contribute between 3% and 16% to project budgets.